

AI Entrepreneur · Full Curriculum

3-session series (90 min each) · 12-16 yrs · Intermediate → Advanced

Full facilitator curriculum **PREMIUM**

Overview

Launch a mini-business using AI tools, ending with a pitch to a panel.

DETAIL	
Track	AI Skills for Kids
Format	3-session series (90 min each)
Ages	12-16 yrs
Level	Intermediate → Advanced
Price	from KES 8,000
Standalone	Yes
Prerequisites	None — standalone

Course Overview

AI Entrepreneur is a three-session sprint in which students build a real mini-business from scratch using AI tools as their design team, copywriter, and coach. Working solo or in pairs, students move from a rough idea to a fully branded, marketed, and pitched business concept — the same workflow used by real founders and startup studios, compressed into three 90-minute sessions.

The arc runs Idea → Product → Pitch. In Session 1, students use AI for market research, generate a business name, design a logo, and lock in a brand colour palette. In Session 2, they build a product mockup or digital product, write marketing copy, and design social posts. In Session 3, they assemble a pitch deck, rehearse with AI acting as a tough investor, and pitch live to a panel that includes invited parents and (where possible) a local entrepreneur or teacher guest judge.

Every student leaves with a complete, tangible take-home: a Brand Kit (name, logo, colour palette, tagline), a Pitch Deck (digital and printed), and a Digital Product Prototype (an ebook cover, app mockup, service flyer, or similar) — all saved to a personal folder they can keep building on after the course ends.

Learning Outcomes

- Frame a real-world problem as a viable mini-business idea and validate it using AI-assisted market research.
- Use generative AI tools (text and image) to produce a business name, logo, and brand colour system that work together as a cohesive identity.
- Write clear, persuasive marketing copy by prompting, evaluating, and editing AI-generated text rather than accepting the first draft.
- Design a product mockup and a set of on-brand social media posts using AI-assisted design tools (Canva Magic Design/Magic Write).
- Build a structured, investor-style pitch deck and rehearse delivery using AI role-play feedback.
- Give and receive constructive peer feedback, and respond to live Q&A from a panel with confidence.
- Understand the ethical and practical limits of AI tools in business (bias, accuracy-checking, originality, giving credit).

Materials Master List

ITEM	SPEC	QTY PER STUDENT/GROUP	NOTES
Laptop or Chromebook	Webcam optional; must run a modern browser (Chrome/Edge); 4GB+ RAM	1 per student (pairs share 1 if devices are limited)	Reserve 2 spares as backups; keep charged overnight before each session
Reliable Wi-Fi / internet	Minimum 10 Mbps shared connection	1 venue connection	Have a mobile hotspot / MiFi as backup; AI image tools are data-heavy
Email account (Gmail or Outlook)	Free personal or school account	1 per student	Needed to sign in to Canva, ChatGPT, Bing Image Creator; set up before Session 1 if possible

Headphones (optional)	Basic wired earbuds	1 per student	Useful for Session 3 rehearsal so pairs don't distract each other
Printed Idea Canvas Worksheet	A4, single page (facilitator-designed one-pager: problem, audience, competitors, name ideas)	1 per student	Provided in Session 1 pack; laminate a few for reuse
Printed Brand Moodboard Template	A4, boxes for logo, 5 colour swatches, tagline	1 per student	Students glue/sketch or write hex codes here
Printed Marketing Copy Worksheet	A4, sections for tagline, caption x3, hashtags	1 per student	Session 2
Printed Pitch Deck Outline	A4, 10-slide skeleton with prompts per slide	1 per student	Session 3, filled before digitising
Sticky notes (3x3 in)	Assorted colours, pad of 100	1 pad per 2 students	Brainstorming and peer feedback rounds
Marker pens (fine + thick)	Black + brand colours (red, blue, green, yellow)	1 set per table of 4	For moodboards and poster sketches
A3 poster paper	Plain white or light colour	1 sheet per student	Optional physical moodboard backup
Whiteboard / flipchart + markers	Standard classroom size	1 per room	Facilitator use for live demos
Projector or large screen + HDMI/USB-C cable	Must mirror facilitator laptop	1 per room	Test before every session
Extension cable / power strip	4-6 outlet, 3-5m cable	2 per room	For charging laptops mid-session
USB drive	16GB+	1 for facilitator	Backup of all templates, fonts, sample decks
Name tags / table tents	Card stock, foldable	1 per student	For Pitch Day — helps panel address students by name
Panel Scorecards	A5, criteria + 1-5 scale + comments box	1 per panellist per student	See Assessment section for criteria
Certificates of completion	A5/A4 printed, editable template	1 per student	Hand out at end of Session 3
Light refreshments	Juice/water + snacks	Enough for students + guests	For Pitch Day showcase with parents

Session Plans

Session 1: Idea & Brand

Objectives

- Turn a real problem into a validated one-line business idea using AI-assisted research.
- Generate and select a business name using AI.
- Design a logo and lock a brand colour palette that work together as a cohesive identity.

Timing (90 minutes)

- 0–10 min: Welcome, course overview, "what is a brand kit" mini-demo showing a finished example
- 10–25 min: Problem-spotting brainstorm + AI market research
- 25–35 min: Idea Canvas Worksheet — students lock one idea
- 35–50 min: AI business name generation
- 50–70 min: AI logo design
- 70–85 min: Brand colour palette + apply to moodboard template
- 85–90 min: Save/export brand kit assets, quick share-out, preview Session 2

Step-by-step

1. Open with a 3-minute story of a real teen-founded business (local example if possible) to set tone.
2. Show a finished sample Brand Kit slide (name + logo + 5-colour palette + tagline) as the Session 1 target.
3. Run a 5-minute whole-group brainstorm: "What's a problem you or your friends deal with weekly?" Collect 8–10 on the whiteboard (e.g. boring school lunches, losing phone chargers, hard to find affordable tutoring).
4. Students pick or invent their own problem and write it at the top of the Idea Canvas Worksheet.
5. Demonstrate the market-research prompt live on the projector using ChatGPT, then let students run their own version.
6. Circulate during the 25–35 min window to help students narrow to ONE clear idea — enforce "one sentence: I help [who] do [what] by [how]."

7. Demo business name generation with two tools (ChatGPT + Namelix), then let students generate and shortlist 3 names each, voting with a table-mate before picking one.
8. Demo logo generation with Bing Image Creator, showing how to refine a prompt after a bad first result. Students then generate their own logos (budget: max 4 generation attempts each to keep pace).
9. Demo Coolers.co palette generation and locking a colour, then students build their 5-colour palette and fill in the Brand Moodboard Template with hex codes.
10. Final 5 minutes: each student says their business name + shows their logo to their table group (30 seconds each).

Build detail

Tools needed: ChatGPT (chat.openai.com, free account, sign in with email), Namelix (no login required), Bing Image Creator (sign in with free Microsoft account — gives image "boosts" for faster generation), Coolers.co (no login required for basic palette generation).

Setup before session: Confirm every student has an email account and can log into ChatGPT and Microsoft (Bing). Pre-create one facilitator account logged in on the projector laptop for live demos.

Workflow — Market research:

I'm a 13-year-old entrepreneur in Nairobi. I want to start a business that helps [target group] solve [problem]. Act as a market research analyst: list 5 similar existing businesses or products (local or global), summarise what each does well, name one gap or complaint customers have about it, and suggest one way my business could be different or better. Keep it simple, no jargon.

A good result: 5 short bullet points with a clear "gap" for each, and at least one genuinely usable difference the student can adopt. If the AI gives vague answers, tell students to reply: "Be more specific — give real examples of Kenyan or African businesses if you can."

Workflow — Business name:

Generate 15 short, catchy business names (max 2 words) for a [type of business] aimed at [audience] in Kenya. Avoid names that are hard to spell or pronounce. Include 3 names that use Swahili or Sheng words.

Students should shortlist 3 favourites, say them out loud (does it sound good?), and check none are already an existing well-known brand. Good result = a name that is short, easy to spell, and hints at what the business does or how it feels.

Workflow — Logo (Bing Image Creator):

Flat vector logo for a business called "[Business Name]", a [industry] brand for teenagers. Minimalist icon of [one simple object related to the business], two-tone colour scheme, rounded modern shapes, no text, clean white background, app-icon style.

Iteration tip: if the logo has text/gibberish in it, add "no text, no letters, icon only" to the prompt. If it's too busy, add "simple, single icon, lots of empty space." Good result = a logo readable at small size (thumbnail-sized) with one clear symbol.

Workflow — Colour palette (Colors.co): Open the generator, press spacebar to shuffle, lock (click the padlock icon) on any colour that matches the logo's dominant colour, keep shuffling the rest until 5 colours feel cohesive. Export/write down the 5 hex codes onto the Brand Moodboard Template.

Testing/iterating: Students hold their printed moodboard next to their laptop logo — do the colours actually match the logo? If not, regenerate 1–2 colours rather than starting over.

Checks for understanding

- "What's the one-sentence version of your business idea — who do you help, and how?"
- "Name one gap in an existing competitor that your idea addresses."
- "Why did you choose these 5 colours together — what feeling are they giving your customer?"

Common mistakes & fixes

MISTAKE	FIX
Idea is too broad ("I want to help everyone with everything")	Force the one-sentence formula: I help [specific who] do [specific what] by [specific how]
Logo prompt generates text/gibberish letters	Add "no text, no letters, icon only" to the prompt

Student accepts the first AI name/logo without reviewing options	Enforce minimum of 2 generation rounds before choosing, and a 30-second "does it sound/look good out loud" test
Colour palette clashes with the logo	Regenerate 1-2 individual colours in Colors rather than the whole palette; use the logo's dominant colour as the locked starting point

Session 2: Product & Marketing

Objectives

- Design a product mockup or digital product prototype that reflects the brand identity from Session 1.
- Write and refine marketing copy using AI, evaluating tone and clarity rather than accepting drafts as-is.
- Design a set of on-brand social media posts using Canva's AI features.

Timing (90 minutes)

- 0–10 min: Recap Session 1 brand kits (quick gallery walk), introduce "product + marketing" goal
- 10–15 min: Decide product type (digital product vs. physical mockup)
- 15–35 min: Build the product mockup/prototype
- 35–55 min: Write marketing copy with ChatGPT (tagline + captions + hashtags)
- 55–80 min: Design 3 social media posts in Canva using Magic Write/Magic Design
- 80–88 min: Peer feedback rotation (gallery walk, sticky-note comments)
- 88–90 min: Save all assets to personal folder, preview Session 3

Step-by-step

1. Open with a gallery walk: students place their printed Brand Moodboard on their desk; everyone circulates for 5 minutes leaving one sticky-note compliment on a neighbour's brand.
2. Explain the two product paths: (a) a *digital product* — e.g. an ebook cover, a printable planner, an app screen mockup, a small guide/checklist; or (b) a *physical product mockup* — e.g. a t-shirt design, a snack packaging label, a poster for a service. Each student/pair picks one path based on their business idea.

3. Demo building a mockup in Canva using a free mockup template (search "product mockup" or "book cover" in Canva's template library), applying their brand logo and colours.
4. Students build their own mockup (20 minutes), facilitator circulates to help with Canva's upload/resize tools.
5. Demo the marketing copy prompt live, showing how to pick the best of 3 AI-generated options and hand-edit one line to make it sound more "them."
6. Students write their own copy on the Marketing Copy Worksheet, then transfer final choices into Canva.
7. Demo Canva's Magic Write (text tool) and Magic Design (template generator) for building an Instagram post, showing how to swap in brand colours/logo via the Brand Kit feature (Canva free version supports one basic Brand Kit).
8. Students design 3 posts: a product announcement, a "problem/solution" post, and a promotional/discount-style post.
9. Run a 10-minute gallery walk / peer feedback: sticky notes with "I like..." and "I wonder..." prompts.

Build detail

Tools needed: Canva (free account, education tier if available — has Magic Write, Magic Design, and Brand Kit features), ChatGPT (same account as Session 1).

Setup before session: Pre-load each student's Canva Brand Kit with their logo file (downloaded from Bing Image Creator in Session 1) and their 5 hex codes so colours are one click away all session.

Workflow — Marketing copy (ChatGPT):

Write 3 versions of a 20-word Instagram caption promoting [product name] for [target audience], each in a different tone: 1) fun and playful, 2) confident and professional, 3) warm and friendly. Add 3 relevant hashtags suitable for a Kenyan teen audience after each caption.

Good result: 3 distinctly different tones, none generic ("Check out our amazing product!" is a red flag — push students to ask the AI to "make it more specific to [product]" if it's too vague). Students pick or blend their favourite and hand-edit at least one phrase so it isn't a pure copy-paste.

Workflow — Product mockup (Canva): In Canva, search the template bar for "mockup" (t-shirt, phone screen, book cover, packaging label depending on product type). Drag the student's logo onto the mockup, use "Edit photo" to recolour background elements to match brand hex codes. For a digital product (e.g. an ebook), use a free "Ebook Cover" template and swap text/colours/logo.

Workflow — Social posts (Canva Magic Design/Magic Write): Click "Magic Design," type a short description e.g. "Instagram post announcing a new [product] for teenagers, playful and bold style" — Canva generates 3–4 template options. Pick one, replace placeholder text using Magic Write (click the text box, select Magic Write, type a short instruction like "write a short exciting caption about our new product launch"), then apply the Brand Kit colours/logo.

Testing/iterating: Read the caption aloud — does it sound like a real business, or like a robot? Does the post look good as a small thumbnail (as it would in an Instagram feed)? If not, increase font size or simplify the layout.

Checks for understanding

- "Which of the 3 AI captions did you choose, and what did you change to make it sound more like your brand?"
- "How does your product mockup use your Session 1 brand colours?"
- "Which of your 3 posts do you think would get the most likes, and why?"

Common mistakes & fixes

MISTAKE	FIX
Copy-pastes AI caption directly with no edits	Require at least one word/phrase change per caption — "make it sound like YOU said it"
Mockup doesn't use the brand's chosen colours/logo	Pull up the Brand Moodboard side-by-side with Canva and manually match each element
Social posts are too text-heavy / unreadable at small size	Preview at thumbnail size (zoom out in Canva); cut text to one short headline + one supporting line
Student spends the whole session perfecting one post and runs out of time	Set visible timers per stage (20 min mockup / 20 min copy / 25 min posts) and give a 5-minute warning

Session 3: Pitch Day

Objectives

- Build a clear, structured pitch deck that tells the business story in under 3 minutes.
- Use AI role-play to rehearse and improve pitch delivery before presenting live.
- Present confidently to a panel and respond to live questions.

Timing (90 minutes)

- 0–10 min: Recap, introduce pitch structure, show one example deck
- 10–30 min: Build pitch deck in Canva (fill printed outline first, then digitise)
- 30–45 min: AI role-play rehearsal (ChatGPT as skeptical investor)
- 45–55 min: Peer rehearsal in pairs with feedback checklist
- 55–60 min: Final prep, panel and room setup, guests arrive
- 60–85 min: Live pitches to panel (parents invited) — approx. 4–5 min per student/pair including Q&A
- 85–90 min: Panel deliberation, certificates, closing remarks

Step-by-step

1. Show a sample 8-slide pitch deck on the projector, pointing out the structure: Problem → Solution → Product Demo → Who It's For → Brand/Marketing → Business Model (how it makes money) → Why Us → Ask (what you need next).
2. Students fill the printed Pitch Deck Outline by hand first (forces clear thinking before design distracts them), then transfer into a Canva "Pitch Deck" template using their Brand Kit.
3. Demo the AI investor role-play prompt live: read a sample pitch aloud into ChatGPT and show the tough follow-up questions it generates.
4. Students run their own pitch through the AI role-play, note down 2 improvements, and revise their deck or talking points accordingly.
5. Pair up students for a 2-minute practice pitch each, partner fills a simple feedback checklist (clear? confident? answered the "why should I care" question?).
6. Set up the room: panel table facing a small stage/presentation area, chairs for parents/guests, projector connected and tested with each student's deck pre-loaded in one shared folder to avoid switching delays.

7. Brief the panel beforehand on the scorecard criteria (see Assessment section) and remind them to ask exactly one question per pitch to keep timing on track.
8. Run pitches in order, facilitator acts as MC, keeps time visibly (use a phone timer visible to presenter), and thanks each student before the next one starts.
9. After all pitches, panel scores are tallied while students and guests mingle with light refreshments; facilitator hands out certificates and reads 2–3 highlight comments (e.g. "most original idea," "best-designed brand") to close on a high note.

Build detail

Tools needed: Canva (Pitch Deck template category, same Brand Kit as Sessions 1–2), ChatGPT (same account).

Setup before session: Pre-search Canva's template library for "Pitch Deck" and bookmark 2–3 clean, simple options to point students toward (avoid overly corporate templates with too much pre-filled jargon). Create a shared Google Drive/Canva folder where every student uploads their final deck as a PDF by the 55-minute mark, so the projector never has to log in/out of accounts during live pitches.

Workflow — Pitch deck outline (8 slides):

1. Title slide — Business name + logo + tagline
2. The Problem — one sentence + a relatable example
3. Our Solution — what the business does
4. Product Showcase — the mockup from Session 2
5. Who It's For — target customer description
6. How We'll Reach Them — 1 sample social post from Session 2
7. How It Makes Money — price, simple cost, who pays
8. The Ask — what they need next (e.g. funding, customers, feedback) + thank you

Workflow — AI investor role-play (ChatGPT):

Act as a skeptical but supportive investor on a Kenyan youth Shark Tank show. I'm going to describe my business pitch below. Ask me 3 tough but fair follow-up questions (about market size, pricing, or competition), then rate my pitch out of 10 and give me 2 specific suggestions to make it stronger.

My pitch: [student pastes their 30-second pitch summary here]

Good result: specific, answerable follow-up questions (not generic "tell me more") and 2 concrete suggestions the student can act on in the next 15 minutes (e.g. "explain your pricing more clearly," "give one real example customer"). Students should revise one slide or one sentence of their spoken pitch based on this feedback — not rebuild the whole deck.

Testing/iterating: Time every practice pitch with a phone timer — target 90 seconds to 2 minutes of talking, leaving room for panel questions. If a student runs long, ask "what's the ONE thing you'd cut?"

Checks for understanding

- "What's the one question you're most nervous the panel will ask — and what's your answer?"
- "What did the AI investor suggest, and what did you change because of it?"
- "In one sentence, why should someone care about your business?"

Common mistakes & fixes

MISTAKE	FIX
Deck has too much text per slide	Enforce "6-word rule" per bullet — if it needs more, it goes in the spoken pitch, not the slide
Student reads directly off the slide instead of speaking to the panel	Cover the screen during practice pitch — force them to explain from memory using only slide images as prompts
Pitch runs over time	Use visible countdown timer during rehearsal; identify and cut the least essential slide/point
Student freezes on a panel question	Teach the "bridge" phrase: "That's a great question — here's what I'd do..." to buy thinking time

Assessment & Showcase

Assessment is formative throughout and summative on Pitch Day. In each session, the facilitator circulates with a simple 3-point checklist (Idea clarity / AI tool use / On-brand consistency for Sessions 1–2; Deck structure / Rehearsal effort / Delivery confidence for Session 3) and gives verbal feedback in the moment rather than waiting until the end.

On Pitch Day, a panel of 3 judges (a mix of facilitators, invited parents, and — where possible — a local entrepreneur or teacher guest) scores each student/pair using a printed scorecard with five criteria, each rated 1–5: *Problem-Solution Clarity*, *Brand & Design Quality*, *Marketing/Product Creativity*, *Delivery & Confidence*, and *Response to Questions*. Scores are used for encouragement and superlative awards (e.g. "Most Original Idea," "Best Brand Identity," "Boldest Pitch") rather than pass/fail — every student who completes all three deliverables passes the course.

"Done" for each student means: a Brand Kit (business name, logo file, 5-colour palette with hex codes, tagline) saved as a folder; a Product Prototype (digital or physical mockup) exported as an image/PDF; a Pitch Deck (8 slides, exported as PDF) delivered live to the panel with at least one question answered. The showcase itself doubles as the celebration — invite parents for the final 30–35 minutes, serve light refreshments, and close with certificates and a group photo.

Extension & Home Challenges

- **Easy:** Design a business card and one additional social media post variation (e.g. a "coming soon" teaser) using the same Canva Brand Kit, keeping all elements — logo, colours, tone — consistent with the original brand.
- **Medium:** Build a simple one-page website mockup for the business using Canva's free website builder (or a template site tool), including a homepage headline, product section, and a call-to-action button; write the homepage copy using ChatGPT and edit it into the student's own voice.
- **Hard:** Create a 30-second product demo video using Canva's video tools (or a phone-recorded voiceover), combining the pitch deck visuals with AI-generated background music suggestions and a written AI-assisted script; additionally, build a simple pricing/cost breakdown (revenue vs. estimated cost) using ChatGPT to help calculate a realistic price point, and add this as a bonus slide to the pitch deck for future use.